

Yang Yan 燕阳

Curriculum Vitae

Assistant Professor

School of Political Science and International Relations, Tongji University

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Homepage

ORCID

ResearchGate

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor , School of Political Science and International Relations, Tongji University, Shanghai, China	Apr. 2026–present
Postdoctoral Researcher , Institute for Chinese Studies, Freie Universität Berlin, Berlin, Germany	Nov. 2023–Feb. 2026
Advisor: Prof. Dr. Genia Kostka	
Postdoctoral Fellow , School of Public Policy & Management, Tsinghua University, Beijing, China	Oct. 2021–Oct. 2023
Advisor: Prof. Angang Hu	
Research Associate , Institute for Contemporary China Studies, Tsinghua University, Beijing, China	Oct. 2021–Oct. 2023

EDUCATION

Ph.D. , Management Science and Engineering, School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications (BUPT), China	Jun. 2021
Thesis: Policy Agenda Setting and the Environmental Governance Performance	
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Chunhui Yuan	
Grade: 94/100 (A-); recognized as an Excellent Doctoral Dissertation of BUPT	
B.A. , Public Administration, School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications (BUPT), China	Jun. 2015
Thesis: The History and Causes of Economic Fluctuations in Germany since the 1970s	
Grade: 92/100 (Excellent)	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Comparative Politics (Chinese Politics); Public Administration and Public Policy.

My research focuses on elite and bureaucratic politics, political communication, and digital politics. I am currently building a database of publicly reported meetings involving provincial leaders in China, which I use to study official-business networks, digital state-business alliances, and local diplomatic networks. I am also conducting survey research on how generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) is influencing policy processes and bureaucratic behavior at the grassroots level in China.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Yang Yan**, Danqi Guo, and Genia Kostka* (2026). "Reassurance and Pride: Narrating and Legitimizing Digital Surveillance in China". *International Political Science Review*. Online first. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01925121261451171>.
- Yang Yan** and Zhusong Yang* (2026). "Aligning Agendas in Public-Activity Reports: Provincial Leaders and Central Signals in China, 2016–2022". *Journal of Chinese Political Science*. Online first. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11366-026-09946-9>.
- Yang Yan** and Genia Kostka* (2026). "Divergent Pathways to Digital China: Unveiling Provincial Digital Agendas Under Top-Level Design". *Journal of Contemporary China*. Online first. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10670564.2026.2665660>.
- Yang Yan** and Zhusong Yang* (2025). Portraying Competence, Benevolence or Party Loyalty? Political Propaganda and the Image Building of Political Elites in China. *Comparative Politics*, 57(4), 529–550. <https://doi.org/10.5129/001041525X17380761641486>.
- Zhusong Yang, **Yang Yan***, and Haoxiang Xu (2024). Towards "All-round Cadres": Policy Priorities and Issue Diversity of Local Bureaucrats in China, 2005–19. *China: An International Journal*, 22(1), 1–24. <https://www.muse.jhu.edu/article/920955>.
- Yang Yan**, Tom Christensen, and Zhusong Yang* (2024). Personnel Control and Local Officials' Attention to Economic Development: Evidence from China. *Administration & Society*, 56(2), 145–171. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00953997231223518>.
- Yang Yan**, Zhusong Yang*, and Chunhui Yuan (2022). Political Attention in a Single-Leading-Party State: A Comparative Study of the Policy Agenda in China, 2003–2019. *Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis: Research and Practice*, 24(2), 138–158. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13876988.2020.1843020>.
- Yang Yan** and Chunhui Yuan* (2020). City Administrative Level and Municipal Party Secretaries' Promotion: Understanding the Logic of Shaping Political Elites in China. *Journal of Contemporary China*, 29(122), 266–285. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10670564.2019.1637570>.

Peer-Reviewed Chinese Articles

- Chunhui Yuan and **Yang Yan** (2020). Central Environmental Inspection: Self-Adaptation of the Pressure Model of Environmental Governance in China <中央环保督察：压力型环境治理模式的自我调适>. *Governance Studies <治理研究>*, 36(1), 57–68. <http://doi.org/10.15944/j.cnki.33-1010/d.2020.01.008>.
- Zhusong Yang, **Yang Yan**, X. Zhang, and J. Zhang (2021). Competence-oriented Cadre Selection of the Chinese Communist Party: Evidence from the Members of Standing Committee of Provincial Party Committee, 1983–2012 <中国共产党干部选任的能力导向——来自省委常委的证据(1983—2012年)>. *CASS Journal of Political Science <政治学研究>*, 3, 26–41.

Yang Yan and Zhusong Yang (2022). The Failure of Agenda-Setting of Local Government in China <地方领导干部政策注意力配置“失灵”现象及其治理>. *Academia Bimestris* <学海>, 197(05), 128–134. <https://doi.org/10.16091/j.cnki.cn32-1308/c.2022.05.007>.

Yang Yan, Yifeng Xian, and Zhusong Yang (2022). Issue-based Politics in China’s Local Governance: An Analysis from the Perspective of Policy Attention <当代中国地方治理中的议题政治学——基于政策注意力视角的分析>. *Humanities & Social Sciences Journal of Hainan University* <海南大学学报人文社科版>, 41(04), 94–104. <https://doi.org/10.15886/j.cnki.hnus.202207.0386>.

Jinglei Huang, **Yang Yan**, and Zhusong Yang (2024). Cadres’ Grassroots Working Experience and Regional Business Environment Construction: An Empirical Study Based on the Resumes of Standing Committee Members of Provincial Party Committees <干部基层工作经历与区域营商环境建设——基于省委常委履历的实证研究>. *Journal of Beijing University of Technology (Social Sciences Edition)* <北京工业大学学报>, 24(04), 77–89.

Conference Paper

Yang Yan. Policy Agendas and Environmental Protection: How Agenda-Setting Matters. *APSA Preprints*. <https://doi.org/10.33774/apsa-2023-8zqlk>.

MANUSCRIPTS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

Manuscripts Under Review

Between Assistance and Verification: Task-Embedded Generative AI Use and Responsibility in China’s Local Government. Under review. Collaborated with Jinglei Huang, Yifeng Xian, and Zhusong Yang.

Calibrated Trust or Blind Reliance? Organizational Governance and Responsible Generative AI Use in Chinese Local Government. Under review. Collaborated with Yifeng Xian and Zhusong Yang.

Who Gets a Meeting? Political Access and State–Business Relations in China. Under review. Collaborated with Dr. María Sol Parrales López, London School of Economics and Political Science.

External Expertise and Partner Selection in Local Governance: Evidence from China. Under review.

Projects in Progress

Taking Sides from Afar: News Narratives, Leader Images, and Chinese Attitudes toward Russia and Ukraine. Collaborated with Dr. Shengxiang Ji.

Signaling Support, Managing Risk: Local Political Elites and the Public Visibility of Private Firms in China.

Does awareness of AI-generated misinformation weaken the persuasive effects of political propaganda? Collaborated with Dr. Yixuan Zhang, Freie Universität Berlin.

Who Builds the Local Digital State? Provincial Leaders and Digital Business Partnerships in China. Collaborated with Prof. Dr. Genia Kostka, Freie Universität Berlin.

BOOKS

Book in Progress

The Face of Authoritarianism: The Propaganda and Public Image of Chinese Political Elites.

Books in Chinese

The Regulation of the Express Delivery Industry <快递市场监管>. Co-editor with Chunhui Yuan. Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications Press, 2019.

Issue-based Politics of State Governance in Contemporary China <当代中国国家治理的议题政治学>. Co-author with Zhusong Yang. Guangming Daily Press, 2024.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

The State Post Bureau Project, “Feasibility Study on the Construction of Postal Industry Technology R&D Center”; team member	2018
National Social Science Foundation Project, “Study on the Logic and Incentive Mechanism of Policy Attention of Chinese Government”; team member	2021–2025
European Research Council, “Digital Governance in China”; team member	2023–2025

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

121st American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada	Sep. 2025
PRIVACY-China Workshop, St Antony’s College, University of Oxford, UK	Jul. 2025
International Conference on China Policy Studies (ICCPs), Beijing Normal University, China	Jun. 2025
Annual Conference of the Political Studies Association (PSA), University of Birmingham and Aston University, UK	Apr. 2025
German Association for Asian Studies (ASC), Annual Meeting, University of Bonn, Germany	Nov. 2024
SCRIPTS Workshop “Sharpening Analytic Instruments of Narrative Contestation During Conflicts,” Freie	Nov. 2024

Universität Berlin, Germany	
120th American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, USA	Sep. 2024
The European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR), General Conference, University College Dublin, Ireland	Aug. 2024
119th American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, USA	Aug. 2023
American Association for Chinese Studies (AACS), Annual Meeting, Virtual Meeting	Oct. 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Modern Economic Theory, guest lecturer and teaching assistant for Prof. Chunhui Yuan, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications	Feb.–Jun. 2016
The Methodology of Social Science Research, guest lecturer, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications	Mar. 2022; Mar. 2023
LV 14228: Theories and Discourses in Chinese Social Science Studies, guest lecturer, Freie Universität Berlin	Nov. 2023; Oct. 2024; Nov. 2025

DISSERTATION SUPERVISION

Assisted in supervising the following graduate dissertations:

Qingyang Li (李清阳), master's in Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2023–2024

Zhen Yu (喻真), Ph.D. in Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2022–2023

Jingyi Hua (华静宜), bachelor's in Public Management, School of Public Policy and Management, Tsinghua University, 2022–2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND EXPERIENCE

Journal Reviewing

Anonymous reviewer: Administration & Society (A&S); Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society (CJRES); Environmental Politics; International Political Science Review (IPSR); Journal of Contemporary China (JoCC); Journal of Electronic Business & Digital Economics; Review of Policy Research (RPR).

Academic Service and Professional Experience

Presenter, Academic Talk: “Policy Agenda-Setting in Comparative Perspective: Theoretical Evolution and Research Frontiers,” Public Policy Speaker Series (#14), School of Government, Beijing Normal University	Jun. 2025
Panel Chair, “Citizens’ Attitudes and Trust in Public Policy,” The 2nd International Conference on Chinese Public Policy, Beijing (Beijing Normal University)	Jun. 2025
Discussant, SCRIPTS Paper Workshop: “Sharpening Analytic Instruments of Narrative Contestation During Conflicts,” Freie Universität Berlin, Germany	Nov. 2024
Panel Chair, “Pathways to ‘Green Policies’ and a Greener Future,” Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association (APSA), Los Angeles, USA	Aug. 2023
Moderator, Academic Lecture: “Contemporary China Studies Overseas: Trends and Developments,” delivered by Prof. Suisheng Zhao (Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver), School of Economics and Management, Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications	Jun. 2019
Panelist, Civil Society 20 (C20) Summit 2017 in Hamburg, Germany	Jun. 2017
Internship, Legambiente Environmental Group, Padova, Italy	Jun.–Jul. 2017
Internship, China Biodiversity Conservation and Green Development Foundation (CBCGDF), Beijing	Feb.–May 2017
Internship, The State Post Bureau, Beijing	Dec. 2015

ACADEMIC HONORS

Excellent Doctoral Dissertation of Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications	Jun. 2021
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LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (native speaker); English (fluent); Korean (TOPIK Level 2).

Statistical analysis: SPSS, Stata, R, Python, and NVIVO.

DATASETS

Publicly Reported Meeting Event Database of Chinese Provincial Political Elites (2005–2024)

Career Database of Political Elites in Chinese Prefecture-level Cities (2001–2019)

Daily News Reports on Activities of Chinese Provincial Political Elites (2013–2023)

Policy Agenda Database of Important Meetings of Chinese Central and Provincial Governments (2008–2023)

REFERENCES

Chunhui Yuan (苑春荟)

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Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications

Genia Kostka

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Institute for Chinese Studies

School of Economics and Management
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